

Benjamin Rohr

Principal, Light Tower Group

Mixed-Use Capital Is Betting on Experience, Not Just Rent

Tuscan Village, a 170-acre mixed-use development near Boston, just signed four new tenants-including Whole Foods and Free People. The leasing tells us something about where capital is flowing in 2026.

Four New Tenants Sign at Tuscan Village

Whole Foods Market, Free People, a boutique fitness concept, and a local restaurant group have all committed to the development. The project is anchored by residential density and experiential retail.

SIGNIFICANCE

Why This Leasing Round Matters

Mixed-use projects have been under pressure as retail and office demand shifted. Tuscan Village is proving that capital still flows to places where people want to live, shop, and gather-not just lease space.

Debt and Equity Are Following the Same Signal

Lenders and investors are underwriting mixed-use differently now. Projects with experiential retail, residential density, and walkable design get better terms. Tuscan Village checks those boxes.

THE REAL QUESTION

What Makes a Mixed-Use Project Financeable Today?

The simple version is: capital wants proof of demand. That means pre-leased retail, strong residential absorption, and a clear operator.

Tuscan Village has all three.

WHO CARES?

Three Parties Watching Closely

Sponsors: This shows mixed-use can still attract anchor tenants.

Lenders: It signals which projects deserve favorable financing.

Investors: It validates the thesis that experience-driven retail has staying power.

MARKET CONTEXT

The Broader Shift Toward Lifestyle-Anchored Real Estate

We're seeing capital flow away from pure retail and toward places that combine living, working, and leisure. Tuscan Village is a case study in that trend.

What to Watch Next

Leasing velocity at Tuscan Village will signal whether the model scales. Also watch: how lenders underwrite similar projects in secondary markets.

THE LESSON

Capital Rewards Projects That People Actually Want to Be In

Tuscan Village shows that mixed-use isn't dead-it's just being held to a higher standard. Light Tower Group helps sponsors and investors navigate these capital markets questions. Connect with Benjamin Rohr for capital strategy and placement.